

MYLAPORE

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Washermenpet » Tondiarpet » Manali » M.R.C.Nagar » Teynampet » Mount Road » Broadway » Kondithope » Tiruvotiyur



Muthiah Street in Vellala Teynampet. PHOTOS: R. RAGU AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



A clogged artery

Located behind DMS Metro and near Stella Maris college and a number of offices and commercial establishments on Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, Muthiah Road in Vellala Teynampet funnels a considerable number of commuters from the station to various destinations in the area. Muthiah Road's job is made harder by 'blocks'



R. RAGU

Muthiah Street in Vellala Teynampet, near Stella Maris College, provides access to DMS Metro station, and during rush hour, this street bustles with pedestrians and moto-

rists. There is a never-ending parade of commuters during these hours, and their movement is hampered by haphazard parking of vehicles, largely those belonging to visitors to four shops on Muthiah Street. Offscourings from these shops left behind on the road add to the impediment.

A resident of the area notes on condition of anonymity that in the early morning hours, this situation causes noticeable disturbance to college students and walkers. The resident adds that haphazard parking is essentially the result of visits to four shops. Grey water and rotten vegetables from a fast food shop and a vegetable shop make it to the road.

Repeated pleas to Greater Chennai Corporation to get these shops to clean up their act by ensuring parking of visitors' vehicles is regulated and the discards disposed of carefully, have not helped, the resident rues.

This road is behind DMS Metro

station, he continues, and given its significant location and the impact it can have on pedestrian and vehicular movement when it 'malfunctions', the rules of the road have to be adhered to more conscientiously.

The residents notes besides students of Stella Maris college, among the major constituents that use this road from DMS Metro are students of Amethi College, Balaji Matriculation Higher Secondary School, police quarters and then a considerable number of commuters heading to offices and commercial establishments on Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai.



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Bus shelters near Vivekanandar Illam **no longer functional**

R. KASIM RAZVI

The public shelters along Marina Inner Beach Road near Vivekanandar Illam have fallen into disrepair, with several structures having gone rusty and a few going without roofs entirely. With showers lashing Chennai often now, regular walkers, visitors and beach goers are likely to face inconvenience. Residents hope reater Chennai Corporation will take up the repair and restoration of the damaged shelters at the earliest to ensure they are safe and ready for public use before the Chennai's main monsoon arrives.

R. Kasim Razvi is a resident of Mylapore



CMRL advisory should be in **multiple languages**

Recently, Chennai Metro Rail Limited warned passengers that playing music or videos without earphones will attract a fine of ₹ 2,500.

On trains and buses, commuters watch reels in large volume, disturbing and inconveniencing their counterparts. CMRL should sensitise commuters and the public in this regard by posting advisory notices in Tamil, Hindi, and English at all the stations.

Metropolitan Transport Corporation should issue a similar advisory and implement the initiative in buses.

P. Sathyanarayayan is a social activist and a resident of Guindy

Safety hazard on roads



A view of Muthu Street and Venkatasamy Street.

At the cross road junction between Muthu Street and Venkatasamy Street, gravel has been dumped on the road instead of being stored within the construction premises. Such practices create unnecessary hazards for motorists, cyclists, and pedestrians. Builders and contractors could store the gravel within the construction site rather than leave it on public roads.

The risks associated with loose gravel are considerable. Motorcyclists are particularly vulnerable to skidding while overtaking or negotiating turns. The danger increases during night driving when visibility is reduced. Gravel can also get scattered by pedestrians, street dogs, passing vehicles, and monsoon rains, spreading the hazard across a larger stretch of road.

I have raised complaints regarding this issue, but no action has been taken yet.

Grievance redressal process

When attempting to report the gravel dumped at Muthu Street and Venkatasamy Street junction, I was informed that the cross-road location itself was not available in the Namma Chennai App.

This must be taken up as citizens should be able to accurately report hazards wherever they occur.

Earlier, I had filed a complaint relating to Muthu Street, but the complaint was closed without the gravel being cleared. I was subsequently asked to file another complaint concerning Venkatasamy Street because the affected cross-road location could not be identified in the application. Such procedural difficulties can delay action on matters directly affecting public safety.

By a concerned resident of Mylapore

You can be **our volunteer writer**

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.



Motorists seek *rumblers* on four roads

East Abhiramapuram Second Street, Bhakthavatchalam Road, Warren Road and C V Raman Road junction have become accident-prone

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Motorists frequenting East Abhiramapuram Second Street, Bhakthavatchalam Road, Warren Road and C.V. Raman Road in Mylapore and Alwarpet have requested Greater Chennai Corporation and the Greater Chennai Traffic Police to install rumblers on the four roads.

Motorists from Second Street



The junction of East Abhiramapuram Second Street, Bhakthavatchalam Road, Warren Road and C V Raman Road in Mylapore. PHOTO: T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

take free left and right turns (a right turn is prohibited), putting themselves on a collision course with motorists from Warren Road and Luz Church Road. Motorists from Warren Road are not supposed to roll through the junction.

Motorists from Luz Church Road come at a breakneck speed on Bhakthavatchalam Road and often seem set to knock over their counterparts negotiating the junction from Second Street and C V Raman Road.

R. Niranjana Ramanathan, a motorist, says, "The junction is accident-prone. Motorists must be very careful and slow down or stop. The risk is higher in the late evening hours. Motorists from Mylapore, Alwarpet and Abhiramapuram speed through the one-way, increasing the risk of accidents."

J. Mariappan, another motorist, says, "Chennai Metro Rail Limited and the traffic police personnel should man the junction. Rumblers are a must on the four roads. The speed breaker on C V Raman Road should be replaced with rumblers as it does not serve its purpose."

PLAN YOUR WEEK

Inter-school quiz competition

Union Christian Matriculation Higher Secondary School in Chetpet will be hosting the 19th edition of its Inter School Quiz Competition 'InQuizitive' for students of classes IX to XII on July 24. Hosted by renowned quiz master Bertie Ashley, the event offers cash prizes to the winners. Calling all Chennai schools to register using the QR Code on or before July 21, 2026



Write to us about events happening in your neighbourhood to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in



Storytelling fest in Mylapore on August 1, 2

Katharoo Fest, a storytelling festival for children, is back this year with the theme "Our Earth, Our Responsibility - Refuse, Reduce, Reuse, Repair, Recycle." The festival will be held on August 1 and 2, from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m., at Sir Sivaswami Kalalaya Senior Secondary School, Mylapore.

According to a press release, the two-day festival will bring together children, families and storytellers through storytelling sessions, puppet shows, workshops, book exchanges, children's book stalls and interactive activities. The event aims to encourage sustainable living by helping participants explore simple, everyday practices that can reduce waste and protect the environment.

This year's festival will feature several hands-on workshops, including a weaving session where participants can create mats using upcycled fabric, craft-based storytelling activities, kolam-making, and an art workshop by award-winning children's book illustrator Nancy Raj. A special session for parents and teachers will focus on using songs while telling stories, says the release.

The festival will also host a Mend Cafe, where participants can learn to repair old clothes by fixing zips, replacing buttons and using applique techniques to give garments a new life. A pop-up thrift stall will showcase reusable accessories, encouraging visitors to move away from a "use and throw" culture.

The festival will also provide a platform for children to share stories of their choice, supporting young voices and encouraging creative expression. Visitors can contribute old books, toys, clothes and dry waste, which will be directed to recycling and segregation initiatives. Participants can register using the QR code, the release adds.

For further details, call 9841013108

Debut exhibition of young artist

Every artist remembers the moment when a blank canvas became a world of endless possibilities.

For young artist Semmozhi Navaladi Raja that moment has blossomed into a solo art exhibition titled 'Genesis - Debut Collection'.

The paintings are not just colours, but hours of observation, imagination, patience, and perseverance. Semmozhi has chosen to express her thoughts and emotions through art, drawing inspiration

from serene landscapes and natural wonders.

The exhibition can be viewed on July 19 at Art Cube Gallery, Virugambakkam, from 10 a.m. to 9 p.m. The exhibition marks the beginning of a young artist's journey and is the result of the support of her family members and mentors, said a release.

The exhibition also features works celebrating India's rich artistic heritage.



Exploration of green campuses in Chennai soon

With a pan-India initiative by Nature Conservation Foundation inviting colleges to create a Campus Biodiversity Register, one can find lists from institutions such as MCC, IIT-M, WCC and Stella Maris making it to iNaturalist, eBird and Season Watch



The sylvan MCC campus.

LIFY THOMAS

The backyard of certain college campuses hardly resemble backyards as we usually understand them: a poky little space, lacklustre, hardly hoofed by human feet. In these colleges, the backyard is an expansive space, supporting an incredible population of furs and feathers; and they pull in human feet given to exploration and documentation of biodiversity.

Classic examples include IIT Madras in Guindy and Madras Christian College in Tambaram. There are also others such as Women's Christian College in Nungambakkam and Stella Maris College in Gopalapuram that lend themselves to making of biodiversity checklists.

Against this green backdrop, Campus Biodiversity Register (CBS) is hugely relevant to Chennai. CBS invites colleges and universities to discover and document the biodiversity on their campuses and build a lasting record of it. An initiative of the Nature on Campus team of the Nature Conservation Foundation (NCF) together with the National Biodiversity Authority, Government of India, the nationwide year-long initiative seeks that students and faculty document biodiversity on their campuses using three citizen science platforms – iNaturalist, eBird and SeasonWatch. WCC, Stella Maris and MCC have doc-

umented the flora, avifauna and fauna on their campuses in the past and brought books on them. From some colleges, the books have also opened their pages to insects. Students of the BSc in Environmental Science and Sustainability and teachers at Azim Premji University in Bengaluru brought out a Campus Biodiversity Register 2024-25 that can be accessed online.

CBR expects these institutions to document their biodiversity with conservation in mind, sustaining endangered species. Besides gaining hands-on experience observing, identifying and documenting species, the participating institutions would be contributing to a global database with their inputs. According to a note on campusbiodiversity.in, by participating one is contributing valuable biodiversity information to global databases as envisioned by the Convention on Biological Diversity while complementing the efforts of the People's Biodiversity Register. The project encourages institutions with just standalone buildings to also sign up for the exercise as biodiversity can be found in the most unexpected places.

There is no fee to participate in this project. Registrations are open till November 2026.

For more details, visit <https://campusbiodiversity.in> or email natureoncampus@ncf-india.org

(MVBB), based in Gopalapuram and run by TTK Group as a service to society, and whenever he receives a call-up from them, he is in attendance at that address the next moment. In April this year, MVBB celebrated its Golden Jubilee.

Shamsudeen elaborates: "As I have a rare blood type, I do not donate blood once in three to four months as many donors do, but donate when there is an emergency, an urgent need for AB Negative. MVBB keeps a record of when I donated blood, and in an emergency, they would call me if I am within the date for donating blood again."

Bookmark this thought: irrespective of whether one's blood group is rare or common, one would do well to be attached to a blood donation organisation so that one gets tuned in to the idea of donating blood as often as they can by virtue of getting timely reminders and urgent call-ups.

Shamsudeen's blood donation tally stands at 22.

As he desired, Shamsudeen's journey as a blood donor has followed the same trajectory as his father's.

(Before proceeding with the how of it, a snapshot of a recent ho-

If you are gripped by a mission to increase the numbers of blood donors, but do not know where to begin, begin at home. Have conversations with your children about your blood donation journey. It sure works: ask the Shaikhs

A leitmotif among blood donation organisations is the increasing difficulty in finding people with "generous veins"; and the solution could strangely be found in the living rooms of households, as illustrated by these two accounts from Chennai of parents inspiring their children to join the cause

Create blood donors at home

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN



Shaikh Shamsudeen and Shaikh Sadaqathullah

nour to the father-son duo. Last month, on World Blood Donors Day, Crescent Blood Donors honoured Shaikh Sadaqathullah and his son Shaikh Shamsudeen for their commitment to blood donation at an event organised at Kavikko Convention Centre in Mylapore. The award was jointly presented by noted film director Ameer Sultan and Ahmed Buhari, trustee of B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science & Technology)

Besides the commitment to donating blood as often they can and the choice to be attached to MVBB, father and son share their blood type, AB Negative. The blood donation tally of Shaikh Sadaqathullah, 56 years old, stands at 53. As Sadaqathullah notes, a tinge of disappointment slipping into his voice for a fleeting moment, he stopped donating blood due to health concerns.

(A trivia: Sadaqathullah is an amateur radio operator and his call sign is VU2SDU)

Sadaqathullah's blood donation journey was initiated at the Perambur Railway Hospital in 1993 where he donated blood responding to a friend's call. "It was then I realised that my blood group was rare. Any negative blood type is considered rare, and AB Negative is rare even among the negative blood types. Globally, 2 per cent of the population has this blood type. Given this, I have not donated at blood donation camps, only when there was an emergency need for AB Negative, and MVBB would call him."

The interviews were with the father and son duo were conducted separately, and what struck was the similarity not only in the language they used, but also the sentiments they expressed.

There is a lesson there, and probably hope too, for blood donation champions such as Srivatsa Vema from the Federation of Indian Blood Donors Organisation (FIBDO) who has expressed concern over a decreasing number of blood donors.

Bookmark this thought too: if you gripped by a mission to increase the numbers of blood donors, but do not know where to begin, begin at home. Have conversations with your children about your blood donation journey. It sure works: ask the Shaikhs.

COLLECTIVE KINDNESS is a column about efforts by voluntary agencies and individual volunteers to shore up processes by public and private enterprises aimed at bringing personal well-being to people

Get started

There are many organisations that drive blood donation on an everyday basis and also through campaigns. Here are some organisations that can help one get started on blood donation.

- Rotary Central TTK VHS Blood Bank being run at Voluntary Health Services (VHS) in Tharamani. Contact: 044-22542829
- Madras Voluntary Blood Bank (MVBB) at 6, Cathedral Road in Gopalapuram, organises blood donations for people in need, connecting donors with those who need blood. Contact: 9841821997/ 9094039538 / 044-28111403 (Saturday and Sunday are off days)
- Crescent Blood Donors at Crescent college campus in Vandalur. Though located at an institution, outsiders can also donate blood after being screened; the group can be contacted for blood donation needs too. Contact: 9087410874
- Through blood donation drives, New College supports blood bank at government hospitals as well as individuals looking for blood donors. The college does not have a dedicated blood bank, but its administrative office can be contacted at 044-28351269/ 28350386
- For donating blood and to receive blood as donation, contact Federation of Indian Blood Donors at 9381005254
- Direction for Volunteers (D4V) conducts blood donation drives and its efforts help medical establishments such as Voluntary Health Services and Institute of Child Health. For details, WhatsApp D4V at 7448888065
- Lions Blood Bank & Research Foundation is located at 130, Marshalls Road in Egmore. For details, call 044-28414949

A family tradition



R. Ravikumar donating blood on March 17, 2026 for the 106th time.

Nanganallur resident R. Ravikumar would not skip certain schedules, some day-based and others occurring every few months, not for all the tea in China. These schedules largely relate to his passion for cycling, running and donating blood. The unwavering commitment to blood donation has put an enviable tally against his name: 106 blood donations, the last donation made on March 17, 2026 at Sunrays Hospital in Ashok Nagar.

Ravikumar, a retired manager from the Oriental Insurance Company Limited, has never viewed blood donation as a mere act of charity. It has been a family legacy, a service that brings him closer to his father's memory: his father was a blood donor, having donated over 50 times in his lifetime. And Ravikumar traces his iron-clad commitment to blood donation to his late father S. Rengarajan's example as well as simple philosophy, which drives his world view. "Even if we cannot help someone financially, we can always serve the society through our actions without expecting anything in return," his father would often say. Inspired by those words, Ravikumar (whose blood type is B Positive) began do-

nating blood at the age of 23 in 1984, the first donation aimed at helping a colleague's wife who was undergoing surgery. To continue this service, Ravikumar has made staying healthy his top priority through regular marathon runs and long distance cycling, believing physical fitness is the reason that he is still able to answer every call for blood.

Since the age of 56, he has participated in numerous endurance events, earning 85 medals. He is also an active member of several blood donation groups in Chennai, continuing to respond to urgent need for donors.

Among the 106 donations, one will always remain etched in his memory. In 2019, after donating blood for a six-year-old cancer patient from Odisha, the child's parents insisted on meeting him. "I told them I had done nothing special, but they still wanted to thank me," he recalls.

The scene that followed will make anyone go teary-eyed. They bowed in gratitude, a gesture that deeply moved him and reaffirmed his belief that compassion knows no language.

While Ravikumar's father donated blood over 50 times, and today his brother R. Ramesh has crossed 60 donations.

What began as one man's quiet belief in selfless service has now grown into a powerful family tradition.

The list of hospitals Ravikumar has donated to include Apollo Hospital in Greams Road, Nandanam Apollo Cancer Speciality Hospital, Vijaya Hospital, Miot Hospital, Egmore Children's Hospital, Adyar Cancer Institute, VHS Blood Bank, various Rotary Club camps, Railway Hospital in Perambur, Sevayala in Thirunindravoor, SIMS Hospital, Chrompet Government Hospital, Rajaji Government Hospital, Sunrays Hospital and WCCG blood donation camps.

Ravikumar is 65 years old now, usually considered the maximum age at which one could donate blood. Exceptions to that rule do exist; and Ravikumar seems set to be an exception.

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Want to understand your city? Try travelling from one end of it to the other. On July 18, fifteen children from the Narikurava community in Pallavaram had the privilege of doing that kind of cross-city travel thanks to "Toxic Tour" organised by Agai - Theatre of Voices in collaboration with Vettiver Collective and Chennai Climate Action Group. These children were being introduced to the industrial north of Chennai where tall chimneys mark the skyline. For the first time, they were setting eyes on thermal power plants, oil refineries and the Adani Port.

At every turn, the children learnt how development was impacting people's everyday lives; more specifically, breathing polluted, toxic air into those lives. This was no awareness tour. The children were wearing the researcher's hat, filing away information for Enge Engal Nadhigal (Where Are Our Rivers?), a year-long puppetry production that has children taking centre stage as storytellers, writing their own scripts.

Architect of this initiative, Agai - Theatre of Voices is a young Gen-Z Chennai collective that seeks to provide a collaborative platform for their own (that is, other members of Gen Z) to work towards social and environmental justice. The philosophy is hardly accidental. It mirrors the journeys of its founders, Tittu (as he prefers to be known) and Nambi Srinivas, both trained social workers whose paths first crossed at the Madras School of Social Work. While Tittu went on to pursue a postgraduate degree at Christ University, Bengaluru and Nambi specialised in community development, theatre became the language that united them long before Agai formally came into existence in 2023. For Tittu, social work dismantled not only career choices, but inherited beliefs. For one, "it made me question the idea that we have to speak for commun-



Children set to *script change*

A year-long puppetry production titled "Enge Engal Nadhigal" by Agai - Theatre of Voices has children from a Narikurava community in Pallavaram taking centre stage as storytellers. As part of this initiative, the children were taken on a tour of the industrial north Chennai on July 18 to understand the negative impact development can have on people's everyday lives and bring that insight into their stories

ities." That conviction deepened after Tittu was selected for Kanthari, the international leadership programme in Thiruvananthapuram, where he was among only three participants from India. There, meeting Sabriye Tenberken, founder of the first blind school in Tibet, re-moulded Agai's ideological compass. "We completely reject the phrase 'voice of the voiceless'," he says. "Everyone already has a voice. What people need is someone willing to listen." And that is Agai's guiding principle now, one informing its initiatives including the programme for the children from the Narikurava community in

The spirit of collaboration

Agai - Theatre of Voices works alongside organisations such as Vettiver Collective, Chennai Climate Action Group and Open House, sharing skills, resources and campaigns rather than guarding ownership.

It is also one of the organisations behind March for Marshlands, a rally scheduled for July 25 at Besant Nagar Beach. Bringing together more than 20 organisations and citizens across Chennai, the rally calls for the conservation of the city's marshlands and stronger action against encroachments and ecologically unsound construction projects, particularly the proposed Mammalam Reservoir project.

Agai also runs a tribal education programme in the Nilgiris, supports digital comics on child rights, operates the Agai Stellar Band that produces music around environmental themes, and conducts youth outreach programmes that introduce urban students to tribal communities through shared experiences instead of surveys and statistics.

Pallavaram.

Again has been working with these children for two months now. No rigid lesson plans; not compulsory practice sessions. Much of the time has simply been spent sitting with the children, making puppets and just talking. Only after that comfort began to emerge did stories begin to surface.

"Once we gave them the puppets, they started speaking automatically," recalls Tittu. "Nothing was prompted. We did not expect it. One child spoke about forests. Another spoke about the River Ganga, even though she has never seen it. The puppets became a space where they could say things adults never asked them."

Those stories will eventually become Enge Engal Nadhigal. Over the coming year, the children themselves will shape the script, perform it and later travel to different parts of Chennai, and eventually other cities using theatre to tell audiences about disappearing rivers, environmental degradation and the worlds they inhabit.

The process matters as much as the performance. "Getting children to stay with us for even one hour is difficult," says Tittu. "One place they do not want to go is school. So we do not recreate school. We do not ask them to sit quietly and listen." Instead, Agai asks adults to do something considerably harder: to listen.

Says Srinivas: "We are simply doing small things and going with the flow." That "flow" has become Agai's operational term.

For Srinivas Nambi and Tittu, going with the flow would mean creating "a forest-based learning space where children enjoy education. We do not want them to adapt to a system. We want to build a system that grows with them." Part of that would be photography programmes, football coaching for tribal youth and creative learning rooted in local knowledge rather than imposed ideas. It is an ambitious vision for a collective that admits financial uncertainty remains its greatest challenge.



During one of the sessions.

PS Senior Secondary School wins 'Best School' title



Seventy-five schools took part in Chettinad Vidyashram's Model United Nations

PS Senior Secondary School in Mylapore was conferred the title of 'Best School' at CVMUN 2026 for outstanding performance across committees. Instituted in memory of Meena Muthiah, the annual flagship event of Chettinad Vidyashram aims to cultivate leadership, public speaking, and diplomatic ac-

men while deepening students' understanding of global affairs.

This is the 18th edition of Chettinad Vidyashram Model United Nations and Secretary General Kethanram C. formally declared the conference open.

More than 1,200 delegates from 75 schools took part in the three-day event.

Principal S. Amudha Lakshmi spoke on the significance of diplomacy and the power of communication in today's interconnected world at the inaugural function.

Chief Guest Rajesh Bhowmick, First Secretary and Head of Chancery, Deputy High Commission of Bangladesh in Chennai, highlight-

ed the pertinence of global conferences and the role of MUNs in shaping young leaders.

Guest of Honour Subhasri Vijayakumar, Head of Information and Library, Goethe-Institut / Max Mueller Bhavan, Chennai, spoke on the historical ties between German and Sanskrit, drawing unique insights from German innovator Johannes Gutenberg.

The committees spanned Geopolitical, Economic, Visual Media, and Print Media domains. Individual delegates were also recognised with Best Delegate, High Commendation, Special Mention, Verbal Mention, and Best Debutant awards, said a release.

Freshers show their talent

The IQAC, Kalalaaya Fine Arts Association and the Department of Physical Education of Sri Kanyaka Parameswari Arts and Science College for Women organised SNIGDA and SPARDHA - Freshers' Talent Hunt recently.

While the off-stage events included miniature art, water rangoli, jewellery making, and treasure hunt, on-stage programmes featured singing and group dance. The programme concluded with

SPARDHA - Sports Day Prize Distribution ceremony.

The SNIGDA Overall Trophy was awarded to B.Com General - Shift II, while B.Sc. Computer Science secured the Runner-up Trophy. The SPARDHA Overall Champion Trophy was presented to the overall champions for their exceptional sporting achievements.

The newly-elected Team Captains were presented with badges as part of the investiture ceremony.



Club partners for hair donation drive

Two young donors - Nithara Nair and Rachel Janette Madhan - who donated their hair to help create wigs for individuals undergoing cancer treatment, were presented with certificates of appreciation as part of the ongoing hair donation drive by Inner Wheel Club (IWC) Chennai Wisteria.

Bodycraft Salon has partnered with IWC Chennai Wisteria as the official hair donation centre. The collected hair will be donated to

The Cherian Foundation, where it will be used to create wigs for cancer patients, helping restore their confidence and bringing hope during their treatment journey, said a release. IWC Chennai Wisteria President Nikitha M. Babu and Danushya, Managing Partner, Tusk Hospitality - Franchise of Bodycraft Salon, Anna Nagar took part.

Bodycraft is at Shop 9/175, 11th Main Rd, A E Block, Block AE, Anna Nagar.

Debut dance performance today

V. Sashwatha, a final year student of B.Sc Electronic Media at M.O.P. Vaishnav College for Women, will give a dance performance on July 19 at Sastra Satsangh auditorium, Vadapalani, behind AVM theatre.

A student of Bharatha Natyalaya Academy of Bharathanatyam and Music, Sashwatha began her artistic journey at the age of nine under the guidance of Swarnamalya Ganesh followed by training under Sivasri

Tejasvi Surya.

She is currently a disciple of Roja Kannan, director Bharatha Natyalaya. Beyond dance, Sashwatha is a versatile visual artist specialising in urban sketching, watercolours and traditional Tanjore painting.

Noted dancer Padma Subrahmanyam will be the chief guest at the event. Historian Chitra Madhavan will be the guest of honour.

Helping achieve financial goals

S. Ramalingam (in picture), an insurance advisor and mutual fund distributor, believes a secure financial future rests on four essential pillars: term insurance, health insurance, systematic investment plans, and systematic withdrawal plans (SWPs).

With 24 years of experience as an Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority-certified insurance advisor and 18 years as an Association of Mutual Funds in India-certified Mutual Fund Distributor, he has



helped individuals and families achieve their financial goals, says a press release.

His services include life, health, personal accident, travel, and international insurance, as well as personalised mutual fund investment solutions.

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Test your knowledge in geography with this quiz for students



The Indian National Cartographic Association (INCA), Tamil Nadu chapter, invites school and college students to participate in the Regional and National Quiz Competition. Designed to encourage geographical knowledge, map-reading skills, current affairs, environmental awareness, and an understanding of geospatial technologies, the quiz will offer participants a platform to demonstrate their knowledge while fostering scientific curiosity and teamwork, said a release.

The event will be conducted in two phases: in phase 1, an online quiz would be conducted at the respective schools of the

participants; and phase 2 at a venue in the city.

Registration and participation fee is ₹100. Participant certificate will be provided and first three prizes will be awarded.

Through workshops, seminars, competitions, and outreach programmes, INCA creates awareness about the importance of maps and geospatial science in education, research, environmental management, disaster mitigation, and sustainable development.

For details, email sujathageobwc@gmail.com or contact P. Sujatha, secretary, INCA Tamil Nadu Chapter at 9840182666

RAPRA's coaching classes begin

Raja Annamalaipuram Residents Association (RAPRA) has helped students from neighbourhood Chennai Schools and Government-aided schools in various ways. For nearly 12 years now they provide financial assistance to the tune of ₹1.6 lakh every year to 40 students, says a press release, adding that apart from this RAPRA is offering coaching free every Sunday for three hours in Accountancy, Economics, Commerce

and Business Maths for Plus One English medium students at R A Puram from 10 a.m. to 1 p.m.

The classes are conducted by experienced and qualified faculty, the release adds.

The students who underwent this free coaching in previous few batches have scored good marks and also have got admission into B Com courses in good colleges purely on merit, says the release.

This year the classes began on

July 18. To make the coaching meaningful only limited number of students are enrolled.

RAPRA is also offering coaching for first year B Com (Finance) Students in Accountancy for two hours every Sunday at RA Puram.

Prior registration is a must for both the classes. Students who wish to join these coaching classes have to call 9841030040 for admission. Decision of RAPRA in enrolling students in final, the release adds.

Young footballers chase their dreams



As football fans around the world gear up for the FIFA final between Spain and Argentina, these students train with infectious enthusiasm at Mullai Nagar Playground in Vyasarpadi. PHOTO : B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM



VISTAS opens AI varsity

Vel's Institute of Science, Technology and Advanced Studies (VISTAS) opened an Artificial Intelligence (AI) vertical university campus on East Coast Road.

Sridhar Vembu, chief scientist and co-founder of Zoho Corporation, inaugurated the campus in the presence of Ishari K. Ganesh, chancellor, Vel's University, and Ahmed Mir Hashim Khouri, a board member of the Emirates Airline Foundation.

The campus features AI-enabled

classrooms, smart learning systems, advanced laboratories, innovation studios, collaborative learning spaces, and digital libraries.

A major highlight of the campus is its Industry-Academia Centres of Excellence, established in collaboration with Intel Unnati, TCS iON, Microsoft, and Oracle Academy, which will provide students with hands-on exposure to AI, cloud computing, high-performance computing, and other emerging technologies.

Sridhar Vembu, co-founder of Zoho Corporation, inaugurates the Artificial Intelligence (AI) vertical university campus in Thiruvanniyur. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Delivering the inaugural address, Sridhar Vembu appreciated the vision behind the new campus and emphasised the importance of building indigenous technologies.

He encouraged students to develop deep technical expertise, embrace lifelong learning, solve real-world problems through innovation, and contribute meaningfully to India's technological advancement.

A Memorandum of Understanding was signed between Vel's University and the Dubai Airlines Group for aviation training, internships, faculty exchange, skill development, and international career opportunities for students.

The varsity will also soon sign an MoU with Zoho Corporation to collaborate in Artificial Intelligence, emerging technologies, research, innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, and industry-academia initiatives, added the release.

Exhibition of silk saris

D. Ravi Silks is holding a silk expo at Kanchi Residency, Anna Nagar, featuring exquisite silk saris combining authenticity and quality.

D Ravi began his career in 1987 as a weaver. Later, he started a small enterprise with six weavers at his home. In 1998, he opened a store in Kancheepuram.

The showroom designs and weaves a variety of Kan-

cheepuram silk saris, with traditional designs inspired by Kancheepuram's temples and the dreams of present-generation women.

The saris woven by more than 250 weavers reflect timeless elegance, exceptional craftsmanship, and the rich heritage of Kancheepuram silk, said a release.

For details, call 90434 44508

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